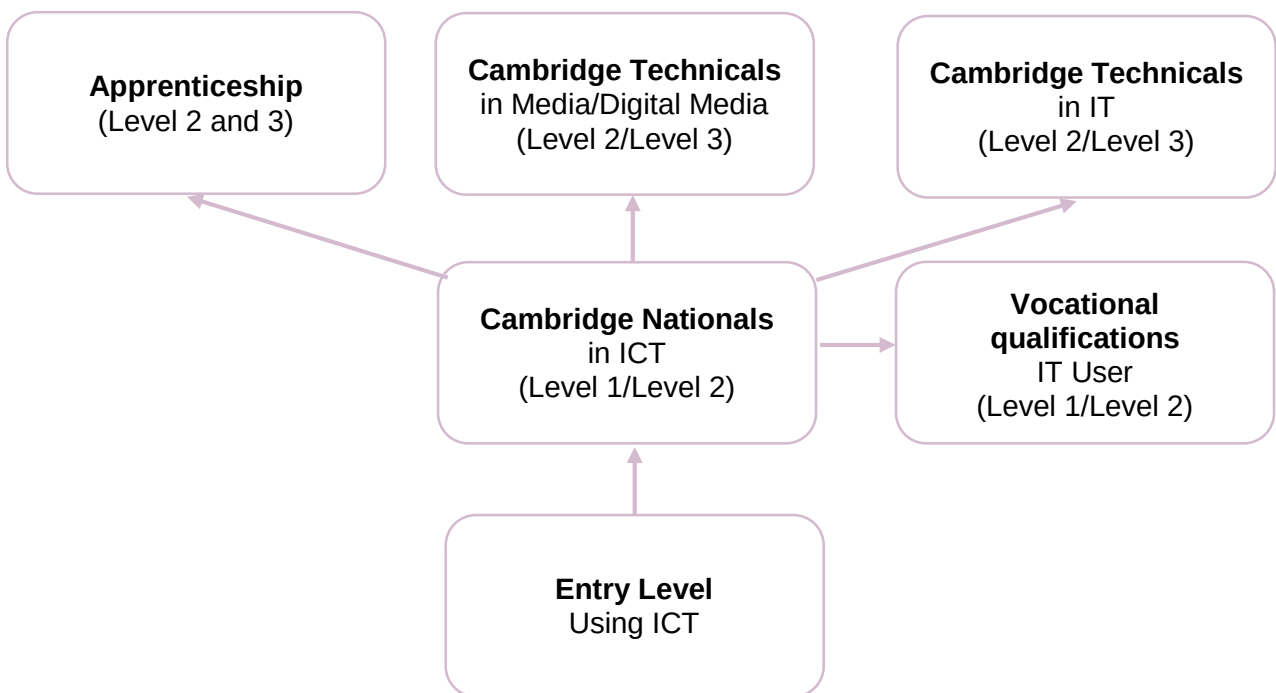


8 Other information

8.1 Overlap with other qualifications

There is overlap of skills and content between the units of this specification and the Functional Skills Qualification in ICT at Level 1 and Level 2.

8.2 Progression from/to these qualifications



Centres are able to use these qualifications to create pathways that provide learners with the underpinning skills and knowledge that will enable them to choose the most appropriate progression routes for their particular needs (further study, Further Education (FE) or employment).

Learners can progress from OCR Level 1/2 Cambridge National Award/Certificate in ICT to other vocational qualifications:

- IT User Skills (Levels 1-3)
- Cambridge Technicals in IT/Information Technology (Levels 2 and 3)
- Cambridge Technicals in Media/Digital Media (Levels 2 and 3).

8.3 Avoidance of bias

OCR has taken great care in preparing this specification and assessment materials to avoid bias of any kind. Special focus is given to the 9 strands of the Equality Act with the aim of ensuring both direct and indirect discrimination is avoided.

8.4 Criteria requirements

This specification complies in all respects with the General Conditions of Recognition.

8.5 Language

This specification, assessment materials and supporting documentation are available in English. Only answers provided in English will be assessed.

8.6 Spiritual, moral, ethical, social, legislative, economic and cultural issues

These qualifications provide potential for centres to develop learners' understanding of spiritual, moral, ethical, social, legislative, economic and cultural issues. This specification offers opportunities to contribute to an understanding of these issues in the following topics.

Issue	Opportunities for developing an understanding of the issue during the course
Spiritual issues	developing knowledge and understanding of: how ICT systems have changed the way people go about their daily lives (including communication, shopping, gaming, entertainment, education and training, banking and financial services, social networking, and online/remote working etc)
Moral issues	learning about appropriate uses of software, malicious use of software and the damage it can cause, and the safe and responsible use of ICT
Ethical issues	- learning about the ethical implications of the electronic storage and transmission of personal information - how ICT systems can affect the quality of life experienced by persons with disabilities and the responsibility to meet individuals access requirements
Social issues	social issues that can affect users of ICT, including the use and abuse of personal and private data, cyber bullying, etc
Legislative issues	- the main aspects of legislation relating to the use of ICT: the computer misuse, data protection, copyright design and patents acts and other legislation as it applies to the use of ICT - the legal implications and consequences for business organisations of data loss
Economic issues	learning about making informed decisions about the choice, implementation, and use of ICT depending upon cost and the efficient management of money and resources
Cultural issues	- helping learners appreciate that ICT contributes to the development of our culture and is becoming increasingly central to our highly technological future - how learners need to show cultural awareness of the audience when communicating with ICT

8.7 Sustainable development, health and safety consideration and European developments with international agreements

These qualifications provide potential to heighten learners' awareness of sustainable development, health and safety considerations and European developments consistent with international agreements.

The specification incorporates learning about relevant health and safety, European and environmental legislation, and could include learning about how each of these factors has affected the use of ICT for businesses and individuals.

Environmental issues

Learners could have the opportunity to learn about how the changes in working practices due to the use of ICT have impacted upon the environment e.g. fewer carbon emissions due to more online/remote working and therefore less travel and environmental issues connected to the production, use and disposal of ICT systems.

Learners could also explore the effect on natural resources of the creation and use of ICT systems including the environmental impact of digital devices and their use, deployment and eventual recycling and disposal.

The understanding of environmental issues will only form part of the assessment requirements where they are relevant to the specific content of the specification and have been identified within the taught content. Learners may choose to produce work that has an environmental theme or to enhance their learning by carrying out further personal study.